QP Code: 25901758

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCEEXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCPJM102 - Digital Journalism and MOJO

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

ANSWER KEY

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks : 70

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. c). Replacing investigative journalism completely

2. a) It captures clearer audio

3. c) Fact-checking and accuracy

4. a) Portability

5. a) Canva

6. b) The visual design and layout

7. d) Selecting anecdotes that illustrate concepts and connect listeners to the material

8. d) It distracts listeners and reduces clarity

9. b) Natural or external light sources

10. c) post-production

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions

Each question carries 3 marks

11. Name three live-streaming platforms used in mobile journalism.

- Facebook Live
- YouTube Live
- Instagram Live
- (Also acceptable: Periscope, Twitch, LinkedIn Live)

12. Why is mobile journalism considered an accessible form of reporting?

- Uses smartphones already owned by most journalists, reducing equipment costs
- Lightweight and compact, enabling reporting from any location instantly
- Requires minimal technical training compared to professional broadcast setups
- Enables solo reporting without a production crew
- Allows real-time publishing directly from the field

13. List three essential accessories used in mobile journalism.

- External microphone (lavalier or shotgun)
- Tripod or gimbal stabiliser
- Portable LED light or ring light
- (Also acceptable: power bank, lens attachments, windshield)

14. Suggest three best practices for incorporating videos in a blog post.

- Keep embedded videos short, relevant, and directly related to the blog topic
- Place videos strategically — near introductions or at key explanatory points
- Add captions or transcripts for accessibility and SEO optimisation
- Ensure videos are mobile-responsive and load quickly
- Use a compelling thumbnail to encourage viewer engagement

15. What is the role of social media in increasing content reach?

- Enables instant sharing across large, networked audiences at zero cost
- Platform algorithms amplify engaging content to wider, targeted audiences
- Hashtags and tagging extend content visibility beyond existing followers
- Encourages audience interaction — shares, comments, and reactions boost organic reach
- Facilitates cross-platform distribution, multiplying touchpoints for the content

16. Define podcast branding. Why branding is important?

- Podcast branding is the process of creating a distinct identity for a podcast through its name, logo, tone, music, and visual design
- It differentiates the podcast from competitors in a crowded market
- Strong branding builds listener loyalty and recognition
- It attracts sponsorships and advertising partnerships
- Consistent branding across platforms establishes credibility and professionalism

17. Identify the key elements that should be included in a podcast content plan.

- Defined target audience and niche topic focus
- Episode format (interview, solo, panel, narrative)
- Publishing schedule and episode frequency
- Episode structure — introduction, main content, call to action
- Guest selection strategy and research framework
- Promotion and distribution plan across platforms

18. Define AI and its role in mobile journalism.

- AI refers to the simulation of human intelligence in machines to perform tasks like learning, reasoning, and problem-solving
- AI-powered tools assist in automated transcription and captioning of audio/video content
- AI enables real-time language translation, expanding audience reach
- Algorithms curate and personalise news content for digital audiences
- AI tools assist in fact-checking, editing, and content optimisation for MoJo journalists

19. Explain the statement 'speed control impact storytelling in a video', with examples

- Speed control refers to adjusting the playback rate of video footage in post-production
- Slow motion emphasises dramatic or emotional moments — e.g., a slow-motion shot of a crowd during a protest conveys intensity
- Time-lapse condenses long processes into short sequences — e.g., a construction site or a sunset to indicate passage of time

- Speed ramping (dynamic speed change) creates cinematic transitions between action and stillness
- Incorrect speed use disrupts narrative flow and disorients the viewer

20. What are the essential steps to follow when launching an E-Zine for the first time?

- Define the niche, target audience, and editorial purpose of the E-Zine
- Choose a publishing platform (Issuu, Canva, Joomag, or a CMS-based website)
- Design a visually consistent layout with a masthead, sections, and typography
- Plan and create content — articles, images, multimedia elements
- Set up a distribution method — email newsletter, website, or social media
- Promote the launch through social media, collaborations, and subscriber campaigns

21. Name two types of microphones commonly used in MOJO.

- Lavalier (clip-on) microphone — used for interviews and solo presentation pieces
- Shotgun microphone — used for directional recording in noisy outdoor environments

22. How can mobile journalism be used effectively in crisis reporting?

- MoJo enables immediate, on-the-ground coverage before traditional broadcast crews arrive
- Journalists can live-stream developing situations in real time directly to audiences
- Compact equipment allows access to restricted or dangerous areas inaccessible to larger crews
- Social media integration allows rapid dissemination of verified updates to wide audiences
- MoJo journalists can simultaneously capture, edit, and publish without returning to a newsroom

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words)

Each question carries 15 marks

23. Compare and contrast the use of smartphones with professional cameras in media production.

- Cost and accessibility: Smartphones are affordable and universally available; professional cameras involve significant investment in equipment and maintenance
- Portability and speed: Smartphones allow instant capture and publishing from any location; professional setups require more setup time and support crew
- Image and audio quality: Professional cameras offer superior resolution, dynamic range, lens options, and audio inputs; smartphones have improving but still limited sensor capabilities
- Workflow: Smartphones enable a complete solo workflow — shoot, edit, publish — via apps; professional production requires multi-stage post-production pipelines
- Use cases: Smartphones excel in breaking news, live reporting, and social media content; professional cameras are preferred for documentaries, broadcast features, and high-end productions
- Adaptability: External accessories (lenses, microphones, gimbals) can narrow the gap between smartphone and professional output for MoJo journalists

24. Explain the various publishing platforms and distribution methods for E-Zines.

- Platforms: Canva, FlipHTML5, and WordPress-based solutions are widely used for creating and hosting E-Zines with interactive, page-flip formats
- Email distribution: Sending E-Zines directly to subscribers via Mailchimp or similar tools ensures targeted, loyal readership
- Website embedding: Hosting the E-Zine on a dedicated website or blog increases discoverability through search engines
- Social media distribution: Sharing excerpts, covers, and links across Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, and Twitter drives traffic and builds audience

- App-based platforms: Publishing on Apple News, Google News, or dedicated reader apps extends reach to mobile-first audiences
- Monetisation options: Platforms like Issuu offer paid subscription tiers, sponsored content placement, and ad-supported distribution models for E-Zines

25. Compare and contrast the advantages of interview-style podcasts versus solo-hosted podcasts.

- Format: Interview podcasts feature conversations between a host and guest(s); solo podcasts are delivered entirely by one host without guests
- Content variety: Interview formats offer diverse perspectives, expert insights, and varied voices; solo formats reflect a consistent, personal point of view
- Production demands: Interview podcasts require guest coordination, scheduling, and sometimes technical challenges with remote recording; solo podcasts are simpler to produce independently
- Audience engagement: Interview-style podcasts attract guests' existing audiences, aiding discoverability; solo podcasts build deeper personal connection between host and regular listeners
- Credibility and authority: Guest-based formats leverage expert credibility; solo formats position the host as a thought leader in their niche
- Flexibility: Solo podcasts can be produced on demand without dependency on guest availability, making scheduling easier

26. Discuss how combining multiple external accessories can enhance the overall quality of mobile video production.

- Stabilisation: Gimbals and tripods eliminate camera shake, producing smooth, professional-looking footage especially during movement
- Audio quality: External lavalier and shotgun microphones dramatically reduce ambient noise and deliver clear, broadcast-quality sound compared to the built-in smartphone mic
- Lighting: Portable LED panels and ring lights ensure consistent, flattering illumination in low-light or indoor environments, improving video clarity and viewer experience
- Lens attachments: Wide-angle, macro, and anamorphic lens attachments expand creative and compositional possibilities beyond the smartphone's native lenses
- Power management: External power banks prevent battery depletion during extended shoots, ensuring uninterrupted field recording
- Combined effect: Using multiple accessories together — stabiliser, external mic, and portable light — bridges the gap between smartphone footage and professional broadcast production standards